

****Impala Streamer**

Thank you for being here.

You're part of a small group seeing Impala before it's public. This isn't a launch. It's a controlled test of whether the core idea works outside my own environment.

What Impala aims to be:

A quiet tool. Predictable. Minimal. Free of the usual noise: accounts, tracking, forced updates, "smart" features that decide things for you. It should feel like a utility — something that stays out of your way.

What I need from you:

Use it the way you actually use your media. Don't handle it gently. Let it run into your real habits, your real library, your real friction. When something feels off, slow, unclear, or wasteful, tell me. Precision is more useful than praise.

What this phase is for:

To confirm the foundation is solid. To expose blind spots. To remove friction before it calcifies into the product. Nothing here is final; everything is adjustable.

Why this matters:

Most software today treats your time as expendable. Impala is an attempt to move in the opposite direction — toward tools that are intentional, quiet, and respectful. This pilot is the first proof of whether that direction is worth pursuing.

For this pilot version, you have access to a library of 60,000 songs and 50 movies. Since I want you to use the app, if there are any artists you would like me to add, please let me know. The library creation will be added in a few weeks.

Impala Streamer — Feature Overview

A quiet, predictable media player.

Impala is built for people who want their media without noise, clutter, or interference. No accounts. No tracking. No recommendations. Just your files, played cleanly and consistently. No sales layer, and NO interface hijacking.

Core Playback

- **Audio + video support** Impala handles both seamlessly, detecting type automatically.
- **Instant start** No indexing, scanning, or preprocessing — files play immediately.

- **Unified controls** A single, simple transport system: previous, play/pause, next.
- **Smart repeat logic** Repeat-one, repeat-off, and natural wrap-around behavior.

Playlists that can be created anywhere

- **Built-in playlists** Clean defaults for shared libraries.
- **Local library playlists** Automatically generated from your own folder structure or JSON.
- **Custom playlists** Create, edit, and reorder your own sets — stored locally, never uploaded.
- **Per-track play toggles** Disable tracks you don't want without deleting them.

Local-First Design

- **Direct file paths** Impala reads your folders exactly as they exist — no database layer.
- **Local audio + video roots** Configure your own directories; Impala builds correct URLs automatically.
- **Flexible JSON import** Supports multiple shapes of library metadata without forcing a schema.

A Player That Remembers

- **Persistent state** Impala restores your last playlist, last track, and last playback state.
- **Session-safe** Browser restarts don't reset your place.

Diagnostics You Can Actually Use

- **Real-time snapshot** Player state, registry state, media resolver info — all visible.
- **Storage health** Per-key byte usage, 4MB warnings, last write status.
- **Error log** Categorized, timestamped, and human-readable.
- **Zero interference** Diagnostics never block playback or break the UI.

Preferences That Stay Out of the Way

- **Color palette selection** Simple, immediate, saved per-browser.
- **Local library configuration** Set audio/video roots and library JSON.
- **No cloud sync** Your preferences stay on your machine.

Security & Simplicity

- **Lightweight authentication** Local token storage with expiration handling.
- **No accounts required for playback** Sign-in is only for shared playlist features.

Built for Stability

- **No background tasks** Nothing runs unless you trigger it.
- **No hidden state** Everything Impala knows is visible on screen.
- **Browser-agnostic** Works consistently across modern browsers.